

this bug. Of course, the parasite isn't yet complex enough to take over our brain. But how long till it evolves, and we...devolve?

How to survive

Watch the movie *Zombieland*. It's a pretty damn good guide to surviving the Zombie apocalypse, at least for the time being. You should also start practicing throwing heavy objects with the goal of crushing something hard, like the head of the undead. We also recommend watching the first two seasons of *The Walking Dead* back-to-back to perfect your technique in zombie killing, which covers everything from sniper shots, to close-range hand-to-hand combat. Remember to make sure not to let any zombie goo get in your mouth or open wounds. Besides tasting like crap, it will also cause the infection to spread through your body.

Once you've got the combat down, remember to always travel in packs. Safety in numbers has definitely worked to the advantage of every protagonist in a Zombie franchise, be it Leon (or Alice) from *Resident Evil* or Columbus (Jesse Eisenberg) in *Zombieland*. Of course, it doesn't hurt to have someone as gorgeous looking as Emma Stone in your entourage, but we wouldn't have you bank on the eventualities.

Why it may not happen

One of the primary reasons a Zombie apocalypse won't end up happening because we're pretty sure nobody is stupid enough to wipe out the entire population of the planet. What would they have to gain from that? Also, if something as dangerous as a T-virus



Hey who said zombies are no fun?

does exist, we're pretty sure that it's locked up so tight that even the people who've locked it up don't know about it. However, we cannot guarantee that some evil scientists aren't already looking into using the *Toxoplasma* parasite as a means to control the minds of the general public. So much can go wrong here!

Doomsday Scenario



Mini Black Hole

We're starting to get serious here now, with stuff that's real. Have you heard about CERN? They're a European organisation whose sole job is to operate what is the world's largest Hardon Collider, the Large Hadron Collider (LHC). The LHC essentially is a large tube through which particles are accelerated to near the speed to light, before making them collide with a target. What results is a beautiful pseudo-cosmic explosion, releasing exotic particles. Scientists hope that in this spray of exotic particles, they will find the Higgs Boson, the elusive, theoretical particle that would help prove string theory and thus give us the one unifying theory of the universe. The problem could arise when the proton-proton collision could theoretically create microscopic black-holes, but scientists say that these would disappear almost instantaneously. But what if they don't? Then there is a crazy bunch of scientists who are (and have) tried to create mini black holes in laboratories for scientific study. Researchers also believe that there are close to 3000 black holes in our galaxy alone, with a Super Massive Black Hole at the very centre, keeping our galactic system in order. If our solar system was to enter anywhere near the gravitational field of one black hole with enough mass, then there is a good chance we're all headed into the gravitational abyss.

How to survive

Well, frankly, short of creating a device that can safely neutralise a black hole,

there's no getting away from this one. We could hope and pray as we get spaghetti-ed into a black hole that at its end, is another black hole, effectively creating a worm-hole, through which we shall all emerge, hopefully safe.

Why it may not happen

So first tackling the concerns with the LHC experiments, the scientists at CERN and many other research labs across the world have said that a microscopic black hole would dissipate much faster than it could absorb anything. The phenomenon is known as Hawking Radiation, where a black hole must give off its mass in the form of particles. If it is unable to absorb mass more than it's giving off, then it dissipates. In the case of micro black holes, this is almost always the case.

Doomsday Scenario



Gamma radiation

No but seriously, cinema aside, Gamma rays are the most dangerous, lethal form of radiation out there. It's pretty much the Chuck Norris of electromagnetic radiation. Nothing's more unforgiving and dangerous. The slightest of exposure to humans can lead to radiation poisoning that can be potentially lethal, and no, it will not turn you into *The Hulk*. Sorry to shatter your "Hulk-Smash" fantasies.

Now the gamma radiation on Earth can come from any kind of nuclear accident/war, but that wouldn't really be enough to wipe us out. What is, however, of significance is the gamma radiation through cosmic events. When a super massive star collapses or two neutron stars collide, a massive amount of gamma radiation shoots out in the direction of the two poles.

Currently, there is a star called the WR104 that is very near the end of its life, about to go Supernova and astrophysicists say that it is turned in our direction. However, if the star does explode, it's not necessary that the result would be a Gamma Radiation Burst,